

Idek flagged

Idek, an acronym for "I didn't even know" gets transactions flagged in Venmo, apparently, following Federal laws. <http://dgit.in/FlagIdek>

**Wiki speech**

Wikipedia again makes a people-friendly move with its new text-to-speech feature in various languages. <http://dgit.in/WikiTalk>

Encryption

SSL. Anyone who's browsed the internet through the confines of their web browser must have encountered the term, if not the scenario, where the browser established an SSL connection. In fact, in 2016, you'd be hard pressed to find a credible, large online business provider that doesn't incorporate SSL connections while

**Encrypt your data with SSL**

engaging with users and sensitive user data. But what is SSL?

SSL's nothing but a short form of Secure Socket Layer, which corresponds to an encryption technique used by web servers to establish secure connections with endpoints to ensure data flows between them in an encrypted format. If a web server connects to a browser over a secure, encrypted connection, the browser highlights the change in the URL as an HTTPS connection (as opposed to regular HTTP connection which is unencrypted), and the appearance of a lock icon. These are web norms that more and browsers are enforcing to warn users whenever they're NOT connecting to a secure web server. For online businesses, regardless of what you're advertising or selling, encryption is an absolute must-have in today's day and age. No wonder hacking is so rampant online because more than 80 per cent of the websites online don't support encrypted connections. It's high time we all changed that, starting with every business owner with a secure website.

While you can definitely create and deploy your own SSL certificate, it's highly recommended to get SSL certificates issued from a verified vendor like Symantec (which bought over VeriSign's secure authentication business) or domain registrars like GoDaddy. SSL security is extremely important for the website

owners who are concerned about secure logins and credit card transactions.

When you're looking to purchase an SSL certificate for your website, make sure you look for one that offers SHA-2 and at least 256-bit encryption.

Authentication

If your business' website has a lot of users logging in with usernames and passwords, make sure you have certain password policies set in place. Make sure you enforce passwords to be updated as often as you can (ideally on a monthly basis), and ensure they have at least alphanumeric and special symbols and be of certain minimum character length (more than 10). Just like you'd notice on forums (like our own Digit forum), make sure you disconnect the user after a certain minimum period of inactivity (5 to 15 minutes). This may sound like a lot of rules to you, but trust us it's only covering the basics as far as Passwords 101 goes in 2016.

If you've used two-factor authentication while logging into Gmail or while executing a credit card transaction on Flipkart or Amazon.in, you can get similar solutions deployed for your website, too. Two-factor authentication essentially makes use of

**Can't go wrong with 2-factor authentication**

your phone (number) to send you a part of the password to successfully login, thereby hoodwinking hackers. There are a number of two-factor authentication services that offer to send uniquely generated codes over SMS or voice. If you're interested in exploring this advanced authentication mechanisms for your website's users, check out <https://2factor.in> which provides OTP (one time password) codes delivered within 2-15 seconds to any mobile phone in India and charges as low as 18 paise for every successful OTP authentication.

CDN

Content delivery networks (CDN) are also worth evaluating in your quest to secure and safeguard your website online. Not only do they ensure super fast delivery of your web pages or online service all across the globe, through a vast array of servers all over the world, it can also be a line of defence in your security strategy when you're website's encountering DoS attacks – and especially if your website happens to go down for some reason.

A security-focused content delivery network (CDN), CloudFlare (among others) is worth looking into. It likes to describe itself as an online community watch, keeping the internet's bad guys from disrupting your online business, and in a nutshell that's true. By adding CloudFlare to your website, you essentially allow it to filter content requests flowing into your website, blocking out all the spam and DDoS elements in the process. It also caches all your website's static and dynamic content across its network of web servers, so even if your website happens to encounter some down time (even for maintenance) a copy of it can always be online and accessible to users from around the world. What's more, CloudFlare is free to use, and it also has paid plans for more serious businesses who don't want to compromise with their website's security and reliability.

While CloudFlare is the most popular free CDN out there (even the Pirate Bay uses it!), there are alternatives like InCapula, Myra Cloud and CDNify that are also worth looking into.

Final thoughts

Last but not the least, don't forget to regularly backup your website – everything from databases, content folders, logs, everything. Depending on the size and scale of your online website's operations, backups should be conducted either on a daily or a weekly basis at max. Also, apart from all the tips thus far, don't forget to stay vigilant at free Wi-Fi hotspots – even if you're inside a hotel. Free almost always means insecure. Invest in a VPN to create encrypted tunnels while connecting to any unfamiliar or unknown network. These are only the first steps towards securing your business' online presence. Best of luck!